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DYNAMITE®

TEEN+

SHERLOCK HOLMES™

THE VANISHING MAN

MOORE
REPPION
OHTA

SHERLOCK HOLMES™
THE VANISHING MAN

NO. 4

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WHOOOOOWHOOOOO

FOR GOD'S SAKE MAN, DON'T SHOOT!

I-I DON'T KNOW WHO YOU ARE, OR WHAT YOU WANT, BUT I'VE NOTHING TO DO WITH THAT MAN!

WAIT A SECOND, YOU...

...YOU'RE MICHAEL WILLIAMS!

TEN HOURS EARLIER.

WHAPP

AGH!

COME NOW, THERE IS NO NEED FOR--

NO *NEED?* WHAT *WOULD* CONSTITUTE A NEED, MR. HOLMES? YOU SAID WE'D BE *SAFE!*

BUT YOU *WERE* SAFE! AT THE ZOO--

SAFE MY FOOT! OUT OF THE WAY FOR SOMEONE TO *RANSACK THE PLACE!*

WHAT IF THEY COME BACK?

WHAT IF THEY WANT A SECOND LOOK AROUND?

"THOSE MEN MEANT BUSINESS, MR. HOLMES.

"THOSE CHILDREN RELY ON US TO KEEP THEM *SAFE!* THAT'S WHY WE TOOK THEM IN! RAISED THEM AS OUR OWN."

I'M AFRAID IT SEEMS THESE PEOPLE WILL NOT GIVE UP UNTIL MICHAEL IS FOUND.

HE'S NOT HERE. HE LEFT FOR WORK THAT MORNING, AND HE HASN'T BEEN SEEN SINCE.

AH, NOW WE ARE AT THE ***CRUX*** OF IT, AREN'T WE?

YOU NEVER WANTED ME TO FIND YOUR HUSBAND, MRS. WILLIAMS.

YOU ENGAGED ME TO ***NOT*** FIND HIM, IN FACT.

IN THAT, STRANGELY, I HAVE ***FAILED.***

A YOUNG ASSOCIATE OF MINE RECOVERED MICHAEL'S BAG, OR RATHER YOUR BAG, BEFORE YOUR PURSUERS COULD FIND IT.

HOW LONG HAVE YOU KNOWN?

"I HAD MY SUSPICIONS, BUT WHEN I SAW THE PHOTOGRAPH I ***KNEW*** THAT YOU AND MICHAEL WERE ONE AND THE SAME.

"AND THE BOOK--'*RUNNING A THOUSAND MILES FOR FREEDOM*'--THE STORY OF ELLEN CRAFT.

"A WOMAN OF MIXED PARENTAGE WHO DISGUISED HERSELF AS A WHITE PLANTATION OWNER TO ESCAPE SLAVERY."

YOUR MOTHER, GEORGIA BORN, KNEW WELL THAT DREAD WORLD BEFORE AMERICA'S THIRTEENTH AMENDMENT WAS PASSED.

SHE IS AN INTELLIGENT, BRAVE WOMAN, AND RAISED YOU TO BE LIKEWISE.

MAY, YOU MUST TELL ME WHAT IT WAS THAT MICHAEL DISCOVERED AT HOOKHAM'S.

WHAT IT IS THAT ONLY ***YOU*** KNOW.

TEN HOURS LATER.

"I FOUND OUT ABOUT THE BURIALS."

Ahem.

EH?

PARDON ME, MY CHILD. I DIDN'T MEAN TO DISTURB YOUR MOMENT OF REFLECTION.

WHAT IS IT YOU WANT, REVEREND?

I ALWAYS LIKE TO HAVE A FEW WORDS WITH THE BEREAVED BEFORE THE SERVICE, IF AT ALL POSSIBLE.

COULD YOU POINT THEM OUT? THROUGH HERE IS IT?

HERE, HANG ON...

COME ON. COME ON.

EGAD!

HOOKHAM HIMSELF!

SILLY OLD JOSSER, POKING HIS NOSE IN.

HOLD UP. WHAT'S GOIN' ON?

DROP SOMETHIN', DID YER?

WHAP

BY DOSE! BY BLUBBY DOSE!

I SUPPOSE I MIGHT BEGRUDGE HIM ALL THIS ***UPHEAVAL,*** YOUR FRIEND MR. HOLMES.

HIS ATTENTIONS HAVE REQUIRED SOME ***DECISIONS*** TO BE MADE, AND EFFORT EXPENDED BY A CONSIDERABLE NUMBER OF PERSONS.

HE'S A CLEVER MAN, MR. HOLMES IS.

AND YET, IT SEEMS TO HAVE BEEN ***HAPPENSTANCE*** THAT ALERTED HIM TO THIS FACET OF MY OPERATION, NOT ***DEDUCTION.***

THINK OF ALL THOSE CRIMES HE MISSES ENTIRELY. WORSE STILL, THOSE HE DISREGARDS ***DELIBERATELY.***

HE IGNORES THE MUNDANE IN FAVOUR OF THE BIZARRE.

ALTHOUGH, I MUST ADMIT, HE DOES SEEM TO HAVE BRUSHED ASIDE THE CASE OF THE VANISHING ARCHAEOLOGIST WHICH HAD BEEN SO NEATLY PREPARED FOR HIM.

HE'S A GOOD MAN, SIR!

HE USES HIS ABILITIES FOR GOOD, BUT ONLY WHEN IT SUITS HIM. ONLY WHEN IT ***AMUSES*** HIM TO DO SO.

YOU HAVE WORKED FOR HIM FOR HOW LONG, WIGGINS, ROUGHLY SPEAKING?

HARD TO SAY, SIR. TWO YEARS, THREE?

SO, ONE MIGHT EXPECT HIM TO BE BASHING MY DOOR DOWN IN HASTE TO RECOVER YOU, YES?

DRIVE ON!

WELL, I DON'T KNOW, SIR. HE HAS BEEN RATHER POORLY OF LATE, TIRED AND SUCH.

WHICH IS WHAT YOU WERE DOING AT THE CHEMISTS, OF COURSE. FETCHING HIS ***PANACEA.***

TURKISH DELIGHT?

HERE, TAKE THE BAG IF YOU LIKE.

I FEAR MR. HOLMES TAKES YOU FOR GRANTED MY BOY.

AND SO, I MUST PERFORCE REMIND HIM...

OH! THE IMPERTINENCE!

YES, THEY DODGE THE FARE TO GO *GOLFING* OF ALL THINGS! CAN YOU BELIEVE IT?

"THAT'S ONE OF THE BLIGHTERS NOW, I'LL WARRANT!"

OI! GET BACK 'ERE!

BLAM
BLAM

GREAT SCOTT!

PTING

=HUFF= YOU'LL GET US *BOTH* KILLED!

Nah, MATE. JUST Y--

BLAM

FOR GOD'S SAKE MAN, DON'T SHOOT!

I-I DON'T KNOW WHO YOU ARE OR WHAT YOU WANT, BUT I'VE ***NOTHING*** TO DO WITH THAT MAN!

WAIT A SECOND, YOU... YOU'RE MICHAEL WILLIAMS!

DIE, WILLIAMS!

BLAM

Mrs. May Williams seemed to me a woman of singular character.

Sole breadwinner for her adopted children, she took *unusual* measures to ensure she was given a rate commensurate with her skills.

Disguised as Michael, she was able to secure a wage more than *double* that of a female clerk.

When she found an anomaly in the accounts, she reported it to her superiors *immediately.*

Little did she know what that decision would cost her.

Michael Williams found himself snarled in a web of calumny and deceit the like of which he had never known.

Only May could get him out of it.

LAUNDRY

She had to ensure Michael was not just *missing,* but gone for good.

MAN THAT IS BORN OF A WOMAN HATH BUT A SHORT TIME TO LIVE, AND IS FULL OF MISERY.

HE COMETH UP AND IS CUT DOWN LIKE A FLOWER.

HE FLEETH AS IT WERE A SHADOW, AND NEVER CONTINUETH--

THANK YOU, REVEREND. I BELIEVE WE WILL HURRY THINGS UP A LITTLE.

RIGHT YOU ARE.

WE'RE RUMBLED! THEY'RE ON TO US!

MICHAEL BLOODY ***WILLIAMS*** WAS ON THAT TRAIN! I FINISHED HIM MYSELF!

THIS HERE'S NONE OTHER THAN THE FAMOUS DR. WATSON!

THAT ***PRIEST'S*** IN IT WITH THEM!

SWIPE

IT'S SHERLOCK BLEEDIN' HOLMES!

KRUMP

HOLMES!

BAMM

KRAK

WHUMP

ACK

UNGH

HOLMES! LOOK OUT!

GOODBYE, DR. WATSON!

BLAM

PING

PING

OH...!

ENOUGH!

THAT'S ENOUGH!

IT IS TOO LATE, WE KNOW ***EVERYTHING.***

YOUR EMPLOYER'S WHOLE OPERATION HERE IS EXPOSED.

HA! YOU KNOW ***NOTHING!***

THAT'S CLOSE ENOUGH, DOCTOR!

MICHAEL WILLIAMS KNEW. STUMBLED ACROSS IT IN THE ACCOUNTS AT HOOKHAM'S.

THAT IS WHY YOUR EMPLOYER WAS SO DESPERATE TO HAVE HIM SILENCED.

"REGULAR, FORTNIGHTLY BURIALS HERE AT BROOKWOOD. THE COFFINS FERRIED VIA THE NECROPOLIS RAILWAY.

NECROPOLIS

"A CLUSTER OF RECURRING NAMES, ALL OF WHICH PROVED INTERCHANGEABLE, FUNDING AND ORGANISING EVERY FUNERAL.

"NAMES OF THE *'DECEASED'* DUPLICATED FROM WORKHOUSE AND PRISON BURIAL RECORDS.

"SO WHAT, OR ***WHO,*** I ASKED MYSELF, WAS ***REALLY*** IN THOSE COFFINS?

"I KNOW TODAY THESE TWO CONTAIN THE BODIES OF MR. HOOKHAM AND MR. ***WITHERS.***

"THEIR SERVICES NO LONGER REQUIRED. THEIR ***ETERNAL*** SILENCE GUARANTEED."

WE'VE CLEARED OUT HOOKHAM'S. THERE'S NOTHING LEFT. NO TRAIL TO FOLLOW.

THERE'S ONLY ***TWO*** LOOSE ENDS, AND I'VE BULLETS ENOUGH FOR ***BOTH*** OF YOU!

BLAM

SORRY I'M A LITTLE LATE, GENTLEMEN...I... =COUGH=

...SEEM TO HAVE GOT OFF THE TRAIN... BEFORE MY STOP...

"I'M SORRY, HOLMES. I DID MY VERY BEST."

LATER.

221B

YOU DID, WATSON, AND SHE'S IN GOOD HANDS NOW. THE ROYAL IS AN EXCELLENT HOSPITAL.

DO YOU THINK THAT WAS IT, HOLMES? DO YOU THINK WE GOT THEM ALL?

ON THE CONTRARY, MY GOOD MAN, I THINK WE MERELY SCRATCHED THE SURFACE.

ONCE W--*GOOD GOD!*

WATSON, HURRY!

HURRY!

PULSE IS THERE, BUT VERY WEAK. PUPILS NOT DILATING AT ALL.

HE IS FLUSHED, PERHAPS SOME KIND OF POISON?

THERE IS NO SPASM IN HIS MUSCLES, SO NOT STRYCHNINE.

HE ALSO LACKS THE PALE LINES ON FINGERNAILS TYPICAL OF ARSENIC.

CYANIDE WOULD FIT HIS COLOURATION.

THIS LACED WITH IT, PERHAPS. A GRADUAL BUILD UP?

CYANIDE POISONING CAUSES SUFFOCATION, JUST LIKE SMOKE INHALATION.

WE NEED A VASODILATOR AND A CYANIDE SCRUBBER, SUCH AS SULPHUR.

AMYL NITRITE! I USE IT TO TREAT ANGINA!

I HAVE SOME I'M SURE...LET ME SEE!

COME ON, WHERE IS IT? SULPHUR, SULPHUR DIOXIDE, ***SODIUM THIOSULPHATE!***

THAT'S THE ONE! NOW, DO I HAVE THE INGREDIENTS TO MAKE IT?

CHEMISTRY

I KNOW I HAD SOME! WHERE IS IT?

IT'S SUCH A TINY TIN!

"FIFTY-THREE GRAMS OF SODIUM CARBONATE TO BE DISSOLVED IN THREE HUNDRED MILI--"

DAMNATION! THERE IS NO ***TIME!***

I HAVE IT! I HAVE THE AMYL!

NOW, THIOSULPHATE, CAN WE FORMULATE IT?

AMYL NITRITE

NO NEED FOR THAT, IT'S HYPOSULPHITE OF SODA! I FIX MY PHOTOGRAPHIC PLATES WITH IT!

WATSON, THE NEEDLE!

shy paper

tography

Hypo

WIGGINS?

MR...MR. HOLMES...?

"HE SAID...I WAS TO TELL YOU...HIS NAME...IT'S..."

PROF. J. MORIARTY

NOK NOK

ENTER!

BEAR WITH ME, I SHALL BE JUST A MO--

DO NOT GET UP, PROFESSOR MORIARTY. THIS WILL NOT TAKE LONG.

I BELIEVE YOU KNOW HOW I CAME TO BE HERE, SO WE MAY OMIT THE ***PLEASANTRIES.***

MR. SHERLOCK HOLMES, HOW ***GRATIFYING.***

I HAVE LONG AWAITED A VISIT FROM THE GREAT DETECTIVE, YET IT SEEMS YOU COULD NOT FIND ME WITHOUT AN EXPLICIT INVITATION.

THAT BOY COULD HAVE BEEN ***KILLED!***

YOU KIDNAPPED HIM, KEPT HIM ***GOD KNOWS WHERE,*** AND THEN ***POISONED*** HIM!

ALL FOR WHAT? TO GET MY ***ATTENTION?*** WELL, SIR, NOW YOU HAVE IT!

FOR A FEW DAYS, YOUNG BERTRAM WIGGINS HAD A ROOF OVER HIS HEAD, A WARM PLACE TO SLEEP, AND THREE SQUARE MEALS.

MORE THAN YOU EVER GAVE HIM, EH?

HOW ***DARE*** YOU--

NOW, NOW, MR. HOLMES. I DO NOT JUDGE YOU, FAR FROM IT.

YOU ARE A FASCINATING *ANOMALY,* BUT BELIEVE YOURSELF MORE IMPORTANT, MORE *INFLUENTIAL* THAN YOU CAN *POSSIBLY* BE.

AND YOU, PROFESSOR? YOU ARE A MAN WHO KNOWS HIS LIMITS, ARE YOU?

ON THE CONTRARY.

I AM A MAN WHO KNOWS NO LIMITS.

YOU, SIR, ARE A *CURSE,* A DISEASE, A *PLAGUE* UPON THIS CITY!

I KNOW THE TRUTH OF HOW FAR YOUR REACH EXTENDS, I HAVE SEEN THE WEB OF *SIN* YOU WEAVE.

I SEE NO ARRESTING OFFICER HERE WITH YOU TODAY?

I AM MERELY A MATHEMATICAL SCHOLAR, A PRIVATE TUTOR TO THOSE WHO WISH TO LEARN THEOREM.

THERE IS NOTHING TO IMPLICATE *ME* IN ANY CRIME.

WHAT LITTLE YOU HAVE SEEN, I HAVE *SHOWN* YOU. *GIVEN* TO YOU.

I ASSURE YOU IT IS BUT THE TINIEST, MOST INSIGNIFICANT, *FRACTION* OF THE WHOLE. THE TIP OF THE ICEBERG.

YOU COULD *STOP* ME, YES, *KILL* ME EVEN, BUT TODAY I OFFER YOU A *PURPOSE.*

BEAT ME, SHERLOCK HOLMES. IF YOU *CAN.*

Those burials previously arranged under the same name as those of Mr. Hookham and Mr. Withers were exhumed.

Hookham's own wife, missing for years, was among the many found within.

A dreadful blackmailer's cache of murder. Weapons and evidence lining the caskets.

The architect of this scheme remains unknown, however. All those who might have provided answers being dead.

Wiggins? He made a full recovery under the watchful eye of Mrs. Hudson.

We rarely see him since he began his studies.

He and Dan, and some of the other Irregulars, attend six mornings a week.

The Williams Free School was founded after some large donations from various official bodies.

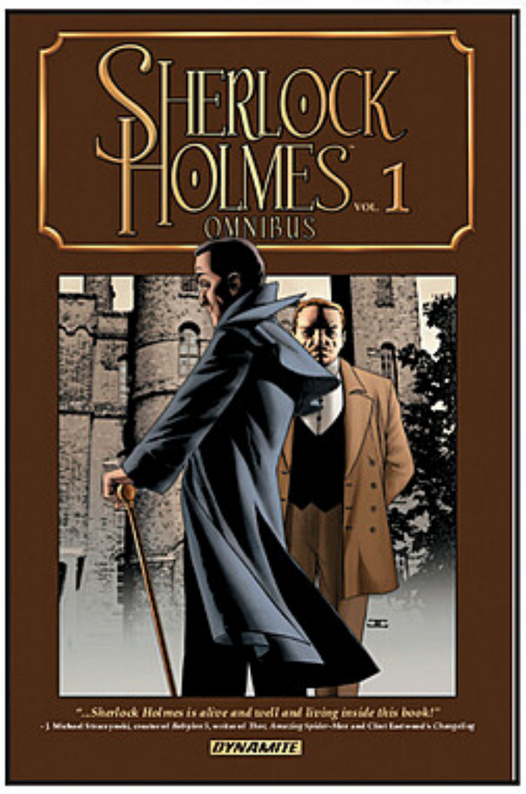
Why? Well, I imagine the talented Mrs. Williams had something to do with it.

She found a new job in the end. Sherlock's brother, Mycroft, making use of her rather *singular* talents.

And that, dear reader, is the end of the Case of the Vanishing Man.

DAMNED SHAME I'LL NEVER BE ABLE TO PUBLISH THE THING!

DYNAMITE® DISPATCH
AUGUST 2018



ALSO AVAILABLE

Presenting three captivating mysteries of Arthur Conan Doyle's beloved sleuth, Sherlock Holmes, in the first-ever Omnibus collecting his comic book adventures! From young Holmes' first encounter with Dr. John Watson, to the detective's role reversal as a suspect for murder, to a rash of Liverpool killings seemingly committed by a supernatural entity, the finest whodunnits in the Dynamite Entertainment library begin with this very volume! Collects the complete "Trial of Sherlock Holmes", "Year One", and "Liverpool Demon" storylines.

WRITER **BILLY TUCCI** TALKS **MISS FURY #1** COMING TO STORES THIS OCTOBER!

With a character like Miss Fury, there is a lot of history involved, she pre-dates Wonder Woman! What is it like to work on such a historic character?

Without a doubt, Miss Fury is one of the most influential characters in comic book history. She proved that costumed female heroes could be hugely successful in an industry dominated by male characters. There is undeniable depth and elegance to Miss Fury, and that is all because of her creator, June Tarpe Mills. Miss Fury, (and her alter ego, Marla Drake) was not the first female superhero, but she was the first created, drawn and written by a woman. During its run, her strips appeared in over 100 newspapers from 1941 to '51. That said, this has been an incredibly exciting, yet daunting task, as there is so much history, twists and characters within Miss Mills' universe. Miss Fury - Joy Division will be set during the darkest days of WWII and will be in line with her true vision that includes her original cast of characters and the intriguing storylines that laced them all together to create an icon.

Why is this story relevant for today?

The tragedy of the Nazi Joy Divisions is one of the world's darkest and least known secrets and it is a important story the must be told. Many recall the band of the same name, but how many know the truth of just what happened to thousands of Jewish women who were rounded up like cattle and forced into sexual slavery for their brutal SS masters? In an age where predators in power are finally being held accountable for their actions, the relevancy of bringing such a horrific subject as the "Joy Division" to the mainstream is paramount. But it is also a completely empowering story of survival and sacrifice as Miss Fury will turn the Joy Division from victims to huntresses known as "The Black Furies" (complete with Fury costumes and weapons) who will turn the tables on their captors by taking the fight directly to them "Inglourious Basterds" style.

What can readers expect when picking MISS FURY up?

Readers will be compelled to pick it up as it is a realistic and modern take on the Golden Age of comics. Though the subject matter is completely serious, we have crafted one hell of an adventure that opens high above the skies of NYC in a vicious air battle against Luftwaffe commandos. In the service of her country, Marla Drake must leave her young son to partake in the bloody liberation of Paris and parachute deep behind enemy lines in Germany. There she must transform the imprisoned women of the Joy Division into warriors that will strike fear into the very heart of the Nazis. There's tons of espionage, action and even humorous moments that can only occur during wartime and what I hope will give readers a new understanding of just what the Nazis were, but more importantly, who Miss Fury is. I want to move people with the storyline, but again, this ultimately is a comic book and it must not only provoke thoughtful discussion, but also entertain.

How did this all come about?

I fell in love with Miss Fury almost 30 years ago and pitched the story to Dynamite. As kismet would have it, they were planning to do a new Miss Fury and literally told them, "You have to let me do this!" After my pitches were approved, editor Anthony Marques showed me the portfolio of artist Emma Kubert and I was simply blown away! I knew from that moment we were on the verge of something truly special. Thanks to Trina Robbins (the foremost living historian on Miss Fury), I've been able to absorb all the original strips and dissect their timelines and characters. There have been several reincarnations of Miss Fury in the decades since Ms. Mills' passing in 1988, but none have struck true to her vision. Ms. Robbins and I are actually getting together during the San Diego Comic Con to discuss Miss Fury and her creator in more depth as we need "Joy Division" to be in tune with Ms. Mills' original storyline, universe and characters. This series will be a true homage to June Tarpe Mills' legacy and that of her immortal creation.

What does Emma Kubert bring to the book as an artist?

Emma is an incredible young talent ready to take on the world! She's a comic book superstar who brings a passion and drive to this series I've not seen in years. Emma, like our heroine Marla Drake is fiercely independent and devoted to making this series a true classic. Her storytelling and drafting ability is astonishing for someone so young. Emma's got a real maturity about her that's a real rarity nowadays, but then again, being the daughter of Andy Kubert, the niece of Adam and the grand-daughter of my hero Joe Kubert, I'm not surprised. I couldn't be more proud to be working with Emma to bring back one of the greatest comic icons in history and, besides, we're having a blast doing it!

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SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN... THIS MONSTER!"